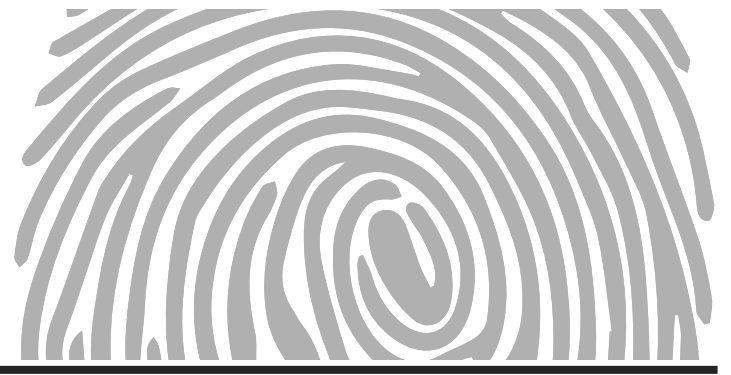


THE SLEUTH

BLACKMAN DETECTIVE SERVICES
(919) 821-0016

NOVEMBER 2024



FROM THE CASE FILES: LET HIM COOK

My mother-in-law has a habit of setting the kitchen on fire every Thanksgiving. While the fire department was assisting with the charred turkey – may it rest in pieces – there was a lot to be grateful for this year. Sure, dinner may have been all too predictably ruined, but here I was, happily spending the holiday with the love of my life (and our 1 year old son!) in our beloved rural town just outside of Raleigh, my football team had been doing great all season, and... *ding* ... Well. Looks like I just got called in for surveillance.

“I’ll bring little Davey to pick up an apple pie from the local bakery,” my wife offered.

“Thanks, sweetie *pie!*” I said, embracing my wife and son with *gratitude*. It was time for a drive.

3 hours later, my work here was almost done. Pulling up to meet the client at the coffee shop downtown before it closed for the holiday ahead, I was *preparing all the sides* of the story in my mind to tell her.

“He stopped talking to me. *Cold turkey*. I know law school has been stressful this past year for him, so I’m concerned. Did you find him?” my client exclaimed. She was a single mother who was baffled why her son no longer communicated with her.

“Well, ma’am, *let’s talk turkey* here. It appears he’s been very inspired by Saxquatch, the musician who plays the saxophone while wearing a Sasquatch costume. A favorite of mine, personally. Your son is a performer; he calls himself “The Gobbler” now. He dresses as a turkey and plays the piano. Sometimes, even, the electric piano. I was posted up at his holiday performance in the park earlier today. His growing fanbase shouts their approval by chanting “Let him cook!” and making turkey noises while he plays.”

“You can’t be serious!” I *gobbled* a piece of my pumpkin muffin to let the news sink in, while she took a weak sip of her pumpkin spice latte.

“I can’t make this stuff up, ma’am. Literally. It is my job to tell you the truth and nothing but the truth, even if it’s not what you want to hear.”

“My son...a *turkey*?” The woman was too stunned to speak. I reassured her that there was no foul play, but her *fowl* certainly played.

“His piano skills are remarkable. You should be very proud!” I reassured her.

“He was in school to become a lawyer! I am unable to believe this!” In response to her newfound emotional stress, the Gobbler’s mother scratched her neck, which was bright red and breaking out into hives, and it shook when she did so, akin to a *turkey’s waddle*.

“Well...apple pie?” she gestured towards the counter, seemingly ready to change the subject. Maybe the *apple* doesn’t fall so far from the tree, after all. I texted my wife: “It’s alright that the turkey was overcooked. Looks like we’ll be having a whole *cornucopia*’s worth of apple pie for dinner!”

A few weeks later, I ran into my client downtown at the coffee shop. She was wearing fan merch, a t-shirt with The Gobbler on the front, sitting across from her decidedly *fowl* son - no law school textbooks in sight. *Thankfully*, it looks like *it’s all gravy* between the two now!

LITTLE RED FLAGS: LYING BY OMISSION



Think someone’s giving you the truth, but not the whole truth?! Here are four warning signs that someone might be lying by omission:

Vague Responses: If someone gives overly general answers or avoids specific details when discussing a topic, it may indicate they’re withholding important information.

Evasive Body Language: Watch for signs of discomfort, such as avoiding eye contact, fidgeting, or turning away. These behaviors can suggest they’re hiding something!

Inconsistent Stories: If their narrative changes over time or doesn’t align with known facts, it could be a sign they’re leaving out crucial details.

Defensiveness: If they become defensive or overly cautious when questioned, it may indicate they’re trying to protect something they don’t want to reveal...

Being aware of these signs can help you gauge whether someone might not be sharing the full truth!

JUST THE (FUN) FACTS: LIFE AS A PI



In the world of private investigations, the ability to blend in can make all the difference! Disguises aren’t just for movie spies; they’re a crucial tool in a PI’s toolkit. Why use disguises? There are two main reasons!

Avoiding Detection: When surveilling a subject, remaining unnoticed is key! A well-chosen disguise can help us observe without raising suspicion, allowing us to gather vital information.

Adapting to Situations: Different environments require different approaches. Whether it’s dressing as a business professional in an office or blending in at a casual social event, adaptability is essential!

LEARN MORE AT WWW.BLACKMANPI.COM



CYBERSECURITY CORNER

MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA)

In today's digital landscape, where data breaches and cyberattacks are becoming increasingly common, protecting sensitive information is more crucial than ever. One of the most effective tools at our disposal is Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).

MFA adds an extra layer of security by requiring not just a password, but also a second form of verification—like a text message code, a fingerprint, or an authentication app. This means that even if a password is compromised, unauthorized access can still be thwarted.

Why should you implement MFA?

Enhanced Security: MFA drastically reduces the risk of unauthorized access. Cybercriminals may steal or guess passwords, but they can't easily bypass the second factor.

Compliance and Trust: For businesses handling sensitive information, adopting MFA can help meet compliance regulations and build trust with clients, showing that you prioritize their security.

Ease of Use: Many MFA solutions are user-friendly and can be set up within minutes. The added security doesn't have to come at the cost of convenience.

As private investigators, we often handle sensitive data and client information. Implementing MFA is a proactive step towards safeguarding that data. Stay vigilant and secure—our investigations depend on it!

NOT TODAY, SCAMMERS!

SCAMS TO KNOW ABOUT: EMPLOYER IMPERSONATION

In employer impersonation scams, fraudsters pose as trusted figures—such as your boss, your boss's boss, or even -gulp!- the IT department—to extract sensitive information like log in credentials or money. They might call, email, or even use social media to create a sense of urgency, claiming that immediate action is required. Their tactics can be incredibly convincing, often using official-looking logos or spoofed phone numbers.

How to Protect Yourself:

Verify Before You Act: Always double-check any request for information or payment. Use official contact details to reach out and confirm legitimacy.

Be Skeptical of Urgency: Scammers thrive on panic. If someone pressures you to act quickly, take a step back and assess the situation.

Educate Your Team: Make sure everyone in your organization is aware of these scams. Regular training can help identify suspicious behavior before it leads to a compromise.

Report Suspicious Activity: If you encounter a potential scam, report it to the appropriate authorities. Sharing information can help protect others from falling victim.

Stay vigilant and empower yourself with knowledge. Together, we can say, "Not today, scammers!"



CLIENT TESTIMONIAL

"Blackman Detective Services always gets the job done, and reliably so! We know we can count on them."



HAVE YOU LISTENED TO THE LATEST EPISODE OF "THE SLEUTH"?

AVAILABLE NOW ON SPOTIFY & APPLE PODCASTS!

KEEP UP WITH US ON SOCIAL MEDIA!

